

Matt Viana

Ph.D. Student in Informatics and Intelligent Systems

Curriculum Vitae

August 2026

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Education

Aug 2025 - Present	Ph.D. in Informatics and Intelligent Systems (Advisor: Dr. Dana Calacci) University Park, PA	Pennsylvania State University
Aug 2022 - May 2025	B.S. in Data Science, Minor in Computer Science University Park, PA	Pennsylvania State University

Research Experience

Aug 2025 - Present	Working Futures Network, Penn State Graduate Research Assistant	Supervisor: Dr. Dana Calacci
	➤ Investigate user behavior and adoption patterns of Large Language Models (LLMs) in real-world settings. ➤ Conduct qualitative research and system audits to identify security vulnerabilities and privacy concerns in AI systems. ➤ Develop novel user feedback mechanisms to mitigate AI mirroring behaviors such as sycophancy and perspective mimesis. ➤ Collaborate on research projects exploring the interpretability of 'black box' AI models.	
Feb 2024 - Jan 2025	Pennsylvania State University AI Research Assistant	Adviser: Dr. Sharon Huang
	➤ Fine-tuned large language models (LLMs) using TensorFlow and PyCharm, incorporating an improved dataset and model published on Hugging Face. ➤ Conducted a literature review on multimodal emotional classification and interaction in large language models (LLMs). ➤ Researched NLP and Computer Vision techniques, focusing on the development of models to analyze a wide emotional spectrum. ➤ Ran experiments integrating audio, visual, and textual inputs into language models, utilizing clustering techniques and data augmentation.	

Publications

2026	Interaction Context Often Increases Sycophancy in LLMs → S Jain, C Park, M M Viana, A Wilson, D Calacci <i>[CHI] ACM CHI 2026 (Accepted, Honorable Mention Award for Outstanding Contribution)</i>
Draft	Active Negotiation: How Users Interact With and Adopt Large Language Models M Viana, P Erickson, D Calacci <i>Draft available upon request</i>

Awards & Funding

2026	Honorable Mention Award Recipient <i>ACM CHI Conference</i>
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- 2025-2026

Jordan Rednor Scholarship
Recipient
College of Information Sciences and Technology
- 2025

ICDS Rising Researcher Grant
Recipient
Institute for Computational and Data Sciences, Pennsylvania State University

Invited Talks

- Feb 2026

Guest Research Talk
University Park, PA

Plain Text Lab (Dr. Jonathan Dodge), Pennsylvania State University
- Dec 2025

Rising Researcher Talk
University Park, PA

Institute for Computational and Data Sciences, Pennsylvania State University

Conference Presentations

- Jun 2026

Interaction Context Often Increases Sycophancy in LLMs (Short Talk)
AI, Metascience, and Methodology, Consortium on Moral Decision-Making \& Center for Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University
University Park, PA

AI and Social Research: Empathic
- Jun 2026

Active Negotiation: How Users Interact With and Adopt Large Language Models (Poster)
Research: Empathic AI, Metascience, and Methodology, Consortium on Moral Decision-Making \& Center for Social Data Analytics, Pennsylvania State University
University Park, PA

AI and Social

Mentoring

- June 2025 - Present

Patrick Erickson
Undergraduate B.S. in Data Science. Research project focused on the adoption and integration of LLMs.

Pennsylvania State University

Skills

- **Research Methods:** Qualitative Analysis, AI Auditing, User Studies, Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)
- **Technical:** Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Natural Language Processing
- **Programming:** Python, R, SQL

Memberships

- 2025 - Present

Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)
- 2025 - Present

Center for Socially Responsible Artificial Intelligence (CSRAI)